

Westbrook University

Office of Academic Affairs

Policy No: ACAD-INT-001

Effective: August 1, 2024

Revision: 1.0

Academic Integrity and Honesty Policy

1. Commitment to Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is a cornerstone of the Westbrook University academic experience. Students, faculty, and staff are expected to maintain the highest standards of scholarly honesty. Violations of academic integrity undermine the value of the degrees conferred by this institution and harm all members of the academic community.

2. Definitions of Academic Dishonesty

2.1 Plagiarism

Presenting another person's words, ideas, data, or creative work as one's own without proper citation. This includes copying text from sources, paraphrasing without attribution, and submitting purchased or AI-generated text without disclosure. See Plagiarism Policy (ACAD-INT-002) for detailed definitions.

2.2 Cheating

Using unauthorized materials or assistance during an exam or assignment. This includes bringing notes to a closed-book exam, using a cell phone during an assessment, copying from another student's work, and unauthorized collaboration.

2.3 Fabrication

Inventing or falsifying data, research results, citations, or other information submitted for academic evaluation.

2.4 Facilitation of Dishonesty

Helping another student commit academic dishonesty, including sharing exam questions, providing answers, or allowing a student to copy one's work.

3. Consequences

Students found responsible for academic dishonesty face consequences proportional to the severity of the violation. Minimum consequences include a zero on the affected assignment. More serious or repeated violations may result in course failure (grade of F) or referral to the Office of Student Affairs for disciplinary action, which may include suspension or expulsion. See Academic Integrity Consequences section in ACAD-INT-002.

4. Reporting

Instructors who suspect academic dishonesty must report the incident to the Academic Integrity Office within 5 business days of discovery using the Academic Integrity Incident Report Form (Form AI-01). Instructors may not impose grade-based penalties without first following this reporting procedure.